

PRIOR AUTHORIZATION REQUEST

CLINICAL JUSTIFICATION:

52-year-old male with 3-month history of progressive lower back pain radiating to left leg (L5). Referred to PT on 2026-05-28. Reports completing 8 weeks of physical therapy without improvement. Failed ibuprofen 800mg TID and gabapentin 300mg TID. Positive SLR at 30 degrees, diminished ankle reflex. No prior lumbar MRI.

CLINICAL DOCUMENTATION

OFFICE VISIT - 2026-06-15

Patient: Robert Chen | DOB: 1972-08-15

Provider: Spine Care Associates

SUBJECTIVE: Patient returns for follow-up. States back pain ongoing for about 3 months. Tried physical therapy - says it did not help. Also tried ibuprofen and gabapentin without relief. Pain radiates down left leg.

OBJECTIVE: SLR positive at 30 degrees left. Ankle reflex diminished left. Sensation decreased L5 dermatome.

ASSESSMENT: Lumbar radiculopathy, L5. Conservative measures failed.

PLAN: Request MRI lumbar spine. Prior auth submitted.

Note: PT referral dated 2026-05-28. Today is 2026-06-15 (18 days). Patient reports 8 weeks of PT - timeline discrepancy noted but not addressed.